

Keeping In LINE— Twins Surprise Denver Bears In 9-4 Exhibition Win Here

By EUGENE FITZGERALD

There were some surprises when the Fargo-Moorhead Twins defeated the Denver Bears, 9 to 4, in Monday's exhibition baseball game here.

It was the second time the Twins had defeated an American Assn. club here. The 1956 Twins, then in last place, had beaten St. Paul here, 13 to 12.

If you are inclined to belittle the surprise victory, you must consider that in professional baseball where two good teams get together either is likely to win. In a series of games, Denver unquestionably would defeat the Twins.

Sure, it was only an exhibition game. But a Class AAA team, even on a day off, doesn't like to be beaten by a Class C club, even if they are in the same farm system.



Fitzgerald

What probably happened is that Denver was a little too sure. The Bears gave up an unearned run, then tied it on John Blanchard's homer.

The Twins got too far away with that four-run uprising in the fourth. Denver realized then it had a job on its hands, but the Twins were out of range.

Don't let the pitching of southpaw Chuck Ziegenbein fool you. He has great potential. The former University of Nebraska athlete showed plenty against Duluth-Superior here last week before he ran into a streak of wildness.

Manager Ken Silvestri behind the bat probably did much for Ziegenbein in that game, possibly giving the young lefthander the confidence he needs to progress.

Manager Andy Cohen of the Bears was disappointed at the way injuries on his club have piled up. The Bears were in the thick of the pennant race in the American Assn. until they started losing some of their top players through injuries.

Andy expects the Bears to make the playoff, unless there are more injuries.

Denver won the Junior World Series last season, and Cohen would like to have the Bears get another shot at it, even though they miss the pennant again.

The Twins, too, are having their troubles afield, largely due to injuries.

Tut Thublin's arm injury, which caused his switch from third base to left field, was helped none by a leg sprain in Sunday's afternoon game here.

Don Brummer had to leave the game Monday because of the recurrence of the cut kneecap suffered in a game at Grand Forks, which kept him out of the lineup.

The Twins had just recovered from a series of colds and akin illnesses as the result of playing in rain in a game at St. Cloud and sitting around in wet toggerly waiting for the game to be resumed.

Frankly, the Twins went on their final road trip with a lot of uncertainties.

Ben Epstein, sports writer for the New York Mirror, died at his home in Manhattan Monday.

Epstein was no stranger to the writers from minor league cities who came to New York almost annually to cover the World Series.

Ben didn't like it in New York. He had been a sports editor at Little Rock, but was attracted by the glamour of the big city. So he went to New York.

At one of the numerous gab-fests which take place in the party room at a World Series, Ben was sitting with a group of minor league writers one night.

He told them they were lucky to be where they are. He said he knew, because he had made the mistake of leaving for the big city.

Epstein would have chosen to leave, but had firm roots by that time, with a son and a daughter in college and a home.

Ben, who was one of the official scorers for the World Series last season, left no doubt but what he wished he had never left Little Rock.

Mrs. Epstein died a year ago. Epstein, who died of a heart attack, was 51.

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